

0.0.1 Makhadeva

1. Thus was heard by me:
At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Mithila, in the Makhadeva Mango Grove. It so happened that the Auspicious One displayed a smile at a certain spot. Then of the venerable Ananda, this occurred: “What is the cause? What is the reason for the Auspicious One’s displaying of a smile? Tathagatas do not display a smile without a cause.” Then the venerable Ananda, having arranged his robe on one shoulder, having stretched out his hands in anjali towards the Auspicious One, said this to the Auspicious One: “What, O Bhante, is the cause? What is the reason for the Auspicious One’s displaying of a smile? Tathagatas do not display a smile without a cause.”

makhādevasuttam

evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā mithilāyaṃ viharati makhādevambavane. atha kho bhagavā aññatarasmiṃ pa-dese sitaṃ pātvā-kāsi. atha kho āyas-mato ānandassa eta-dahosi: ko nu kho hetu, ko paccayo bhagavato sitassa pātukammāya? na akāraṇe tathāgatā si-taṃ pātukarontī’ti. atha kho āyasmā ānando ekaṃsaṃ cī-varaṃ katvā yena bhagavā tenañjalim-pañāmetvā bhaga-vantaṃ etadavoca: ko nu kho bhante hetu, ko paccayo bhagavato sitassa pātukammāya? na akāraṇe² tathāgatā sitaṃ pātukarontī’ti.

2. Once upon a time, O Ananda, in just this Mithila, there was a king named Makhadeva, a righteous, lawful king who stood firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and he observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.

3. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Makhadeva addressed his barber: “when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber replied to king Makhadeva. Then from the lapse of many years,

bhūtapubbaṃ ānanda, imissāyeve mithilāyaṃ rājā ahosi makhādevo³ nāma dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme ṭhito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu⁴ cepi jānapadesu ca. uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasim aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa.

atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo bahunnaṃ⁵ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ acayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passēyyāsi sirasmim palitāni⁶ jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi’ ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa paccas-

many hundreds of years,
 many thousands of years,
 many hundreds of thousands
 of years, O Ananda, the bar-
 ber saw that grey hairs have
 emerged on king Makhadeva's
 head. Having seen, he said
 this to king Makhadeva: "The
 divine messengers have ap-
 peared. The emergence of
 grey hairs have been seen
 on your head." "Well then
 good barber, having carefully
 pulled out the grey hairs with
 tweezers, place them in my
 cupped hand." "Yes, your
 majesty," O Ananda, the bar-
 ber having replied to king
 Makhadeva, having carefully
 pulled out the grey hairs with
 tweezers, place them in king
 Makhadeva's cupped hand.

sosi. addasā kho
 ānanda, kappako ba-
 hunnaṃ vassānaṃ
 bahunnaṃ vassasa-
 tānaṃ bahunnaṃ
 vassasahassānaṃ
 accayena rañño ma-
 khādevassa siras-
 miṃ palitāni jātāni.
 disvāna rājānaṃ ma-
 khādevaṃ etada-
 voca: pātubhūtā kho
 devassa devadūtā,
 dissanti sirasmiṃ pa-
 litāni⁶ jātānī'ti. tena
 hi samma kappaka,
 tāni palitāni sādhu-
 kaṃ saṇḍāsena ud-
 dharitvā mama⁷ añ-
 jalismiṃ patitṭhā-
 pehī'ti. evaṃ devāti
 kho ānanda, kap-
 pako rañño makhā-
 devassa paṭissutvā
 tāni palitāni sādhu-
 kaṃ saṇḍāsena ud-
 dharitvā rañño ma-
 khādevassa añjalis-
 miṃ patitṭhāpesi.

4. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go

atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo kap-pakassa gāma-varam datvā jeṭṭhaputtam kumāram āmantāpe-tvā etadavoca: pātu-bhūtā kho me tāta kumāra devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ pa-litāni jātāni, bhuttā kho pana me mānu-sakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariye-situṃ. ehi tvaṃ tāta kumāra, imaṃ raj-jaṃ paṭipajja. ahaṃ pana kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāra-smā anagāri-yaṃ pabbajissāmi. tena hi tāta kumāra, yadā tvampi passey-yāsi sirasmiṃ pali-tāni jātāni, atha kap-pakassa gāma-varam datvā jeṭṭhaputtam kumāram sādhu-kaṃ rajje samanūsāsivā kesamassuṃ ohā-

forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man.”

5. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly

retvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāasmā anagāriyam pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ¹ nihitam anuppavattēyyāsi. mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosi. yasmiṃ kho tāta kumāra, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchēdo hoti so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tāhaṃ tāta kumāra, evaṃ vaddāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitam anuppavattēyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosī’ti.

atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo kappakassa gāmaṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhuṃ

instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the

rajje samanūsāsivā imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane ke-samassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajī. so mettāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharivā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ,² iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharivā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe-muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharivā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ² iti

fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

6. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Makhadeva amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world.

uddhamadho tiriyaṃ
sabbadhi sabbatta-
tāya sabbāvantam
lokaṃ upekkhāsaha-
gatena cetasā vipu-
lena mahaggatena
appamāṇena ave-
rena abyāpajjhena
pharitvā vihāsi.

rājā kho panānanda,
makhādevo caturā-
sītivassasahasāni
kumārakīḷitaṃ kīḷi,
caturāsītivassasahasāni
oparajjaṃ³ kā-
resi, caturāsītivassa-
sahasāni rajjaṃ kā-
resi, caturāsītivassa-
sahasāni imasmiṃ-
yeva makhādevam-
bavane agāasmā
anagāriyaṃ pabba-
jito brahmacariyaṃ
cari. so cattāro brah-
mavihāre bhāvetvā
kāyassa bhedā pa-
rammaraṇā brahma-
lokūpago ahosi.

7. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Makhadeva's son addressed his barber: "when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me." "Yes, your majesty," O Ananda, the barber replied to king Makhadeva's son. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Makhadeva's son's head. Having seen, he said this to king Makhadeva's son: "The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head." "Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers,

atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasa-hassānaṃ accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: 'yadā me samma kappaka, passey-yāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi'ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa puttassa paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasa-hassānaṃ accayena rañño makhādevassa puttassa sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni. di-svāna rañño makhādevassa puttaṃ etadavoca: 'pātubhūtā kho devassa deva-

place them in my cupped hand.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Makhadeva’s son, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Makhadeva’s son’s cupped hand.

dūtā, dissanti siras-
mim palitāni jātānī’ti.
tena hi samma kap-
paka, tāni palitāni
sādhukaṃ saṇḍā-
sena uddharitvā mama
aṅgalismim patitṭhā-
pehī’ti. evaṃ devāti
kho ānanda, kap-
pako rañño makhā-
devassa puttassa
paṭissutvā tāni pa-
litāni sādhukaṃ saṇ-
ḍāsena uddharitvā
rañño makhādevassa
puttassa aṅgalismim
patiṭṭhāpesi.

8. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva’s son, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been

atha kho ānanda,
rañño makhādevassa
putto kappakassa
gā mavaram datvā
jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumā-
raṃ āmantāpetvā
etadavoca: ‘pātu-
bhūtā kho me tāta
kumāra devadūtā,
dissanti siras-
mim palitāni jātāni, bhuttā
kho pana me mānu-

enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved of hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to

sakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariyesitum. ehi tvaṃ tātā kumāra, imaṃ rajjaṃ paṭipajja. ahaṃ pana kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajissāmi. tena hi tātā kumāra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmim palitāni jātāni, atha kapakassa gāmvaram datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhuṃ rajje samanūsāsivā kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavattēyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosi. yasmim kho tātā kumāra, puri-

you my son prince, say thus:
 “Continue in succession this
 good custom laid down by
 me. Let you not be my last
 man.”

sayuge vattamāne
 evarūpassa kalyā-
 ṇassa vaṭṭassa sa-
 mucchedo hoti, so
 tesam antimapuriso
 hoti. taṃ tāhaṃ tāta
 kumāra, evaṃ va-
 dāmi: yena me idaṃ
 kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ
 nihitaṃ anuppavat-
 teyyāsi, mā kho me
 tvaṃ antimapuriso
 ahoṣī’ti.

9. Then, O Ananda, king
 Makhadeva’s son having
 given an excellent village
 to the barber, having thor-
 oughly instructed the el-
 dest son, the prince, in the
 kingdom, in this Makhadeva
 Mango Grove, having shaved
 off hair and beard, having
 put on the brownish robe,
 went forth from the home
 life into homelessness. With
 a mind imbued with metta,
 he dwelled pervading one
 direction, likewise the sec-

atha kho ānanda,
 rañño makhādevassa
 putto kappakassa
 gāmavaraṃ datvā
 jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumā-
 raṃ sādhukaṃ rajje
 samanūsāsivā ima-
 miṃyeva makhāde-
 vambavane kesa-
 massuṃ ohāretvā
 kāsāyāni vatthāni ac-
 chādetvā agāraṣmā
 anagāriyaṃ pabbajī.
 so mettāsahagatena
 cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ
 pharivā vihāsi, ta-

ond direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

thā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya¹ sabbāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe-muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekam disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi.

10. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Makhadeva's son amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world.

11. The sons of sons of king Makhadeva, O Ananda, eighty four thousand kattiyas in succession, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth

rañño kho panānanda, makhādevassa putto caturāsītivassasahasāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīḷi, caturāsītivassasahasāni oparajjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahasāni rajjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahasāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahmacariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokūpago ahoṣi.

rañño kho panānanda, makhādevassa puttappaputtakā² tassa paramparā caturāsītikhattiyasahasāni³ imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane keśamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni ac-

from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, they dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, they dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great,

chādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajīṃsu. te mettāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā viharīṃsu, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ.⁴ iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantāṃ lokaṃ mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā viharīṃsu. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā viharīṃsu. tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantāṃ lokaṃ upekkhāsahagatena

immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

12. For eighty four thousand years [as children] they amused themselves with children games. For eighty four thousand years they occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years they ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, they went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, they fared on to the brahma world.

13. King Nimi was the last of those kings, a righteous, lawful king who stood firm in the Dhamma, a great king

cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā viharimṣu.

te caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīlīṃsu, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjaṃ¹ kāresuṃ, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjaṃ kāresuṃ, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmimyeva makhādevambavane agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajitā brahmacariyaṃ carimṣu. te cattāro brahmvihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokūpagā ahesuṃ.

nimi tesam rājā rājānaṃ² pacchimako ahosi dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme ṭhito

who fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and he observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight. Once upon a time, O Ananda, the Tavatimsa devas, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, this topic of conversation arose as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs for the videhans, it is well-gained indeed sirs for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.”

mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇa-gahapatikesu ne-gamesu ceva jāna-padesu ca, uposa-thañca upavasati cā-tuddasiṃ pañcada-siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pak-khassa. bhūtapub-baṃ ānanda, devā-naṃ tāvatimsānaṃ sudhammāyaṃ sa-bhāyaṃ sannisinnā-naṃ sannipatitānaṃ ayamantarākathā udapādi: ‘lābhā vata bho videhānaṃ, su-laddhaṃ vata bho videhānaṃ, yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme ṭhito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā’ti.

14. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed the Tavatimsa devas: Do you, dear sirs, wish to see king Nimi? We, dear sirs, wish to see king Nimi. At that time, on the fifteenth day of the lunar fortnight, that being the uposatha day, king Nimi having washed his head, having gone to the upper floor of his lofty palace, was seated observing the uposatha. Then, O Ananda, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so Sakka, ruler of the devas, disappeared among the Tavatimsa devas and appeared in front of king Nimi.

atha kho ānanda,
sakko devānamindo
deve tāvatimse āman-
tesī: ‘iccheyyātha
no tumhe mārīsā,
nimim rājānaṃ daṭ-
ṭhunti icchāma ma-
yaṃ mārīsa, nimim
rājānaṃ daṭṭhunti.
tena kho pana sa-
mayena nimi rājā
tadahuposathe pan-
narase sasīsaṃ na-
hāto³ uposathiko
upari pāsādavara-
gato nisinno hoti.
atha kho ānanda,
sakko devānamindo
seyyathāpi nāma ba-
lavā puriso sammiñ-
jitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pa-
sāreyya, pasāritaṃ
vā bāhaṃ sammiñ-
jeyya, evamevaṃ
devesu tāvatimsesu
antarahito nimissa
rañño pamukhe pā-
turahosi.

atha kho ānanda,

15. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, said this to king Nimi: “It is a gain for you, great king, it is well-gained for you, great king. The Tavatimsa devas, O great king, having assembled at the Sudhamma assembly hall, are singing your praises as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs for the videhans, it is well-gained indeed sirs for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” We the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, wish to see you. I, O great king, will send a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses for you. Climb aboard that divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.”

sakko devānamindo
nimim rājānaṃ eta-
davoca: ‘lābhā te
mahārāja, suladdhaṃ
te mahārāja. devā
te mahārāja, tāva-
timsā sudhammā-
yaṃ sabhāyaṃ kit-
taya mānarūpā san-
nisinnā: ‘lābhā vata
bho videhānaṃ, su-
laddhaṃ vata bho
videhānaṃ, yesaṃ
nimi rājā dhammiko
dhammarājā dhamme
ṭhito mahārājā dham-
maṃ carati brāh-
maṇagahapatikesu
negamesu ceva jā-
napadesu ca, upo-
sathañca upavasati
cātuddasaṃ pañcada-
siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pak-
khassā’ti. devā te
mahārāja, tāvatimsā
dassanakāmā, tassa
te ahaṃ mahārāja,
sahassayuttaṃ ājañ-
ñarathaṃ paṇiṇis-
sāmi, abhiruheyyāsi

King Nimi, O Ananda, consented by silence. So then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, having known of king Nimi's consent, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so Sakka, ruler of the devas, disappeared in front of king Nimi and appeared among the Tavatimsa devas.

mahārāja, dibbaṃ
yānaṃ avikampa-
māno'ti. adhivāsesi
kho ānanda, nimi
rājā tuṇhībhaṇa.
atha kho ānanda,
sakko devānamindo
nimissa rañño adhi-
vāsaṇaṃ viditvā sey-
yathāpi nāma balavā
puriso samiñjitaṃ
vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya,
pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ
samiñjeyya, evame-
vaṃ nimissa rañño
pamukhe antarahito
devesu tāvatimsesu
pāturahosi.

16. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed Matali, the charioteer: "Come you good Matali, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, having approached king Nimi, you say thus: "This chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses,

atha kho ānanda,
sakko devānamindo
mātalisaṅgāhakaṃ
āmañtesī: ehi tvaṃ
samma mātali, sa-
hassayuttaṃ ājañ-
ñarathaṃ yojetvā
nimiṃ rājānaṃ upa-
saṅkamitvā evaṃ va-
desī: 'ayaṃ te ma-
hārāja, sahassayutto

O great king, has been sent by Sakka, ruler of the devas, for you. Climb aboard the divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.”“Yes Lord,” O Ananda, Matali, the charioteer, having replied to Sakka, ruler of the devas, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, having approached king Nimi, said thus: “This chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, O great king, has been sent by Sakka, ruler of the devas, for you. Climb aboard the divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.”“But great king, by what [route do you prefer to be] led by me? That by which those who do evil kamma experience the results of their evil kamma or that by which those who do good kamma experience the results of their good kamma?” “Just lead me, O Matali, by both.” Matali, the charoteer,

ājaññaratho sakkena devānamindena pesito. abhiruheyysī mahārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno’ti. evaṃ bhaddantavāṭi1 kho ānanda, mātali saṅgāhako sakkassa devānamindassa paṭissutvā saḥassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ upasaṅkamitvā etadavoca: ‘ayaṃ te mahārāja, saḥassayutto ājaññaratho sakkena devānamindena pesito, abhiruha mahārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno. api ca mahārāja, katamena taṃ nemi, yena vā pāpakammā pāpakānaṃ kammānaṃ vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvedenti, yena vā kalyāṇakammā kalyāṇānaṃ kammānaṃ vipākaṃ paṭi-

O Ananda, led king Nimi to Sudhamma assembly hall. Sakka ruler of the devas, O Ananda, saw king Nimi approaching from afar. Having seen, he said this to king Nimi: “Come great king, welcome great king, the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, having assembled at the Sudhamma assembly hall, are singing your praises as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs for the videhans, it is well-gained indeed sirs for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” We the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, wish to see you. Take delight, O great king, in divine power among the devas.” Enough,

saṃvedentī’ti? ubhaya-
yeneva maṃ mātali
nehīti. sampāpesi²
kho ānanda, mātali-
saṅgāhako nimim
rājānaṃ sudham-
maṃ sabhaṃ.³ ad-
dasā kho ānanda,
sakko devānamindo
nimim rājānaṃ dū-
ratova āgacchantam.
disvāna nimim rājā-
naṃ etadavoca: ehi
kho mahārāja, svā-
gataṃ⁴ mahārāja,
devā te⁵ mahārāja,
tāvatiṃsā sudham-
māyaṃ sabhāyaṃ
kittayamānarūpā
sannisinnā: ‘lābhā
vata bho videhānaṃ,
suladdhaṃ vata⁶
bho videhānaṃ, ye-
saṃ nimi rājā dham-
miko dhammarājā
dhamme ṭhito mahā-
rājā dhammaṃ ca-
rati brāhmaṇagaha-
patikesu negamesu
ceva jānapadesu ca.

dear sir, Lead me back just there to Mithila. there I will fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Household-ers, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” So then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed Matali, the charioteer: “Come you good Matali, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, lead king Nimi back just there to Mithila.” “Yes Lord,” O Ananda, Matali, the charioteer, having replied to Sakka, ruler of the devas, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, led king Nimi back just there to Mithila.

uposathañca upava-
sati cātuddasiṃ pañ-
cadasīṃ aṭṭhamiñca
pakkhassā’ti. devā
te mahārāja, tāva-
tiṃsā dassanakāmā,
abhirama mahārāja,
devesu devānubhā-
venā’ti. alaṃ mārīsa,
tattheva maṃ mithi-
laṃ paṭinetu. tat-
thāhaṃ dhammaṃ
carissāmi brāhma-
ṇagahapatikesu ne-
gamesu ceva jāna-
padesu ca, uposa-
thañca upavasissāmi
cātuddasiṃ pañcada-
siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pak-
khassā’ti. atha kho
ānanda, sakko devā-
namindo mātali sañ-
gāhakaṃ āmantesi:
ehi tvaṃ samma mā-
tali, saḥassayuttaṃ
ājaññarathaṃ yo-
jetvā nimīṃ rājā-
naṃ tattheva mithi-
laṃ paṭinehīti. evaṃ
bhaddantavāti kho

17. Just there, O Ananda, king Nimi fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Nimi addressed his barber: “when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber replied

ānanda, mātali saṅgāhako sakkassa devānamindassa paṭisutvā saḥassayuttam ājaññaratham yoje tvā nimiṃ rājānaṃ tattheva mithilaṃ paṭinesī.

tatra sudam ānanda, nimi rājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇa-gahapatikesu ne-gamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasīṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa. atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ⁷ accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, atha me

to king Nimi. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Nimi's head. Having seen, he said this to king Nimi: "The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head." "Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in my cupped hand." "Yes, your majesty," O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Nimi, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Nimi's cupped hand.

āroceyyāsī'ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako nimissa rañño paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasa-hassānaṃ accayena nimissa rañño siras-miṃ palitāni jātāni. disvāna nimim rājānaṃ etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā, disanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni'ti. tena hi samma kappaka, tāni palitāni sādhu-kaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā mama añjalismiṃ patitṭhā-pehī'ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako nimissa rañño paṭissutvā tāni palitāni sādhu-kaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā nimissa rañño añja-

17. Then, O Ananda, king Nimi, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kin-

lismim patitṭhāpesi.

atha kho ānanda,
nimi rājā kappakassa
gāmavaram datvā
jeṭṭhaputtam kumā-
ram āmantāpetvā
etadavoca: ‘pātu-
bhūtā kho me tāta
kumāra devadūtā,
dissanti sirasmim pa-
litāni jātāni, bhuttā
kho pana me mānu-
sakā kāmā, samayo
dibbe kāme pariye-
situm. ehi tvam tāta
kumāra, imam raj-
jam paṭipajja. aham
pana kesamassum
ohāretvā kāsāyāni
vatthāni acchādetvā
agāasmā anagāri-
yam pabbajissāmi.
tena hi tāta kumāra,
yadā tvampi passey-
yāsi sirasmim pali-
tāni jātāni, atha kap-
pakassa gāmavaram
datvā jeṭṭhaputtam
kumāram sādhuḥkam

dom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man.”

18. Then, O Ananda, king Nimi having given an ex-

rajje samanūsāsivā kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāraśmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ anuppavattēyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahoṣi. yasmaṃ kho tāta kumāra, purisaṃ yuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchēdo hoti so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tāhaṃ tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: ‘yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ anuppavattēyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahoṣī’ti.

atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā kappakassa gāmaṃ datvā

cellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the

jetṭhaputtam kumāram sādhukam rajje samanūsāsivā imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāasmā anagāriyam pabbajī. so mettāsahagatena cetasā ekam disam pharivā vihāsi, tathā dutiyam, tathā tatiyam, tathā cattuthim itī uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantaṃ lokaṃ mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharivā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe-muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekam disam pharivā vihāsi, tathā du-

second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

19. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Nimi amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on

tiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi.

nimi kho panānanda, rājā caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīli, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjam kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjam kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agāraasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahmacariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokū-

to the brahma world. King Nimi's son, O Ananda, was named Kalarajanaka. He did not go forth from the home life into homelessness. He cut off that good custom. He was the last man of those.

20. Now it might be, O Ananda, that it occurs to you thus: Surely some other person was king Makhadeva who laid down that good custom at that time. But this should not be seen thus. I was king Makhadeva at that time. I laid down that good custom. That good custom laid down by me was continue in succession by later generation. However, O Ananda, that good custom did not lead to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening,

pago ahosi. nimissa kho panānananda, rañño kalārajanako nāma putto ahosi. so na agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ samucchindi. so tesam antimapuriso ahosi.

siyā kho pana te ānanda, evamassa: añño nūna tena samayena rājā makhādevo ahosi yena¹ taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihi-tanti.² na kho pane-taṃ ānanda, evaṃ datṭhabbaṃ. ahaṃ tena samayena rājā makhādevo ahosiṃ. ahaṃ taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiniṃ.³ mayā taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ pac-chimā janatā anup-pavattesi. taṃ kho panānanda, kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ na nibbi-

to nibbana, [but] only for arising in the brahma world.

21. However, at present, O Ananda, this good custom laid down by me lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana.” And what at present, O Ananda, is that good custom laid down by me which lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana? It is just this noble eight-fold path. That is, right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right samadhi.

dāya na virāgāya na nirodhāya na upasamāya na abhiññāya na sambodhāya na nibbānāya saṃvattati, yāvadeva brahmalokūpapattiya.

idaṃ kho paṇānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati. katamā cānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati: ayameva ariyo aṭṭhaṅgiko maggo. seyyathidaṃ: sammādiṭṭhi sammāsaṅkappo sammāvācā

This, at present, O Ananda, is that good custom laid down by me which lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana. That I to you all, O Ananda, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let none of you be my last man.” Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you all, O Ananda, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let none of you be my last man.” This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, the venerable Ananda rejoiced in the Auspicious One’s words.

sammākammanto
sammāājīvo sam-
māvāyāmo sammā-
sati sammāsamādhi.
idaṃ kho ānanda,
etarahi mayā kalyā-
ṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ
ekantanibbidāya vi-
rāgāya nirodhāya
upasaṃyāya abhiñ-
ñāya sambodhāya
nibbānāya saṃvat-
tati. taṃ vo ahaṃ
ānanda, evaṃ va-
dāmi: yena me idaṃ
kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ ni-
hiṭaṃ anuppavattēy-
yātha, mā kho me
tumhe antimapurisā
ahuvattha. yasmim
kho ānanda, puri-
sayuge vattamāne
evarūpassa kalyā-
ṇassa vaṭṭassa sa-
mucchēdo hoti so
tesaṃ antimapuriso
hoti. taṃ vo ahaṃ
ānanda, evaṃ va-
dāmi: yena me idaṃ
kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ

nihitaṃ anuppavat-
teyyātha. mā kho
me tumhe antima-
purisā ahuvatthā'ti.
idamavoca bhagavā
attamano āyasmā
ānando bhagavato
bhāsitāṃ abhinan-
dīti.

